Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 3: Landforms and Life

Book: Exploring Society: India and Beyond | CBSE | Simple English Question–Answers

इस अध्याय में पृथ्वी की प्रमुख स्थलाकृतियों (landforms), उनके प्रकार, प्राकृतिक विशेषताओं, मानव जीवन, व्यवसाय, संस्कृति और उनसे जुड़ी चुनौतियों का अध्ययन किया गया है। नीचे अध्याय के प्रत्येक प्रमुख विषय से महत्वपूर्ण प्रश्न-उत्तर, textbook activities और अभ्यास के उत्तर सरल अंग्रेज़ी में दिए गए हैं।

Topic 1: Introduction to Landforms

Q1. What is a landform?

Answer: A landform is a physical feature on the surface of the Earth.

Q2. What are the three main types of landforms?

Answer: The three main types of landforms are mountains, plateaus, and plains.

Q3. How are landforms formed?

Answer: Landforms develop over millions of years due to natural processes such as movements inside the Earth, volcanic activity, weathering, and erosion by rivers, wind, and ice.

Q4. What is altitude?

Answer: Altitude is the height of a place or object above sea level.

Q5. How do landforms affect human life?

Answer: Landforms affect climate, farming, transport, housing, occupations, food habits, and culture. People adapt their lifestyles to the landforms in which they live.

Q6. What are flora and fauna?

Answer: Flora means the plant life of a region. Fauna means the animal life of a region.

Q7. Why do different landforms have different types of flora and fauna?

Answer: Different landforms have different climates, soils, water supplies, and living conditions. These differences support different plants and animals.

Q8. What is resilience?

Answer: Resilience is the ability to face difficulties, adapt to challenges, and overcome them.

Topic 2: Mountains







Q9. What is a mountain?

Answer: A mountain is a landform that rises much higher than the surrounding land. It usually has a broad base, steep slopes, and a narrow summit.

Q10. What is a mountain summit?

Answer: A summit is the highest point of a mountain.

Q11. What are the main features of mountains?

Answer: Mountains are high, often have steep slopes, and may have snow-covered peaks. They generally have cooler climates than nearby lowlands.

Q12. What are young mountains?

Answer: Young mountains are mountains formed relatively recently in geological history. They often have high peaks and steep slopes.

Q13. What are old mountains?

Answer: Old mountains have existed for a very long time. Erosion often makes their peaks lower and more rounded.

Q14. Are the Himalayas young or old mountains?

Answer: The Himalayas are young fold mountains. Many of their peaks are high and rugged.

Q15. Which is the highest mountain in the world?

Answer: Mount Everest is the highest mountain in the world, with a commonly stated height of about 8,849 metres above sea level.

Q16. What are the Tibetan and Nepali names for Mount Everest?

Answer: Tibetans call it Chomolungma, meaning “Mother Goddess of the World”. Nepalis call it Sagarmatha, meaning “Goddess of the Sky”.

Q17. Why are some mountains covered with snow?

Answer: Temperatures decrease with altitude. Therefore, high mountains are often cold enough for snow to remain on their peaks.

Q18. Why are mountains important?

Answer: Mountains are sources of many rivers, support forests and wildlife, provide water, and attract tourists. They are also important religious and cultural places.

Q19. What is a valley?

Answer: A valley is a low area between hills or mountains, often with a river or stream flowing through it.

Q20. What is terrace farming?

Answer: Terrace farming is a method of farming in which steps are cut into mountain slopes to create flat fields.

Q21. Why is terrace farming practised in mountains?

Answer: It creates flat land for cultivation, reduces the speed of flowing rainwater, and helps control soil erosion.

Q22. What are the main occupations of people living in mountains?

Answer: Their main occupations include farming, animal rearing, forestry, tourism, and handicrafts.

Q23. Why is transport difficult in mountainous areas?

Answer: Steep slopes, narrow roads, landslides, heavy snowfall, and rough terrain make transport difficult.

Q24. What are the challenges of living in mountains?

Answer: People may face cold weather, difficult transport, limited farmland, landslides, and difficulty in accessing schools and hospitals.

Q25. Why do tourists visit mountains?

Answer: Tourists visit mountains for their natural beauty, cool climate, trekking, skiing, mountaineering, and religious pilgrimages.

Q26. Who was Bachendri Pal?

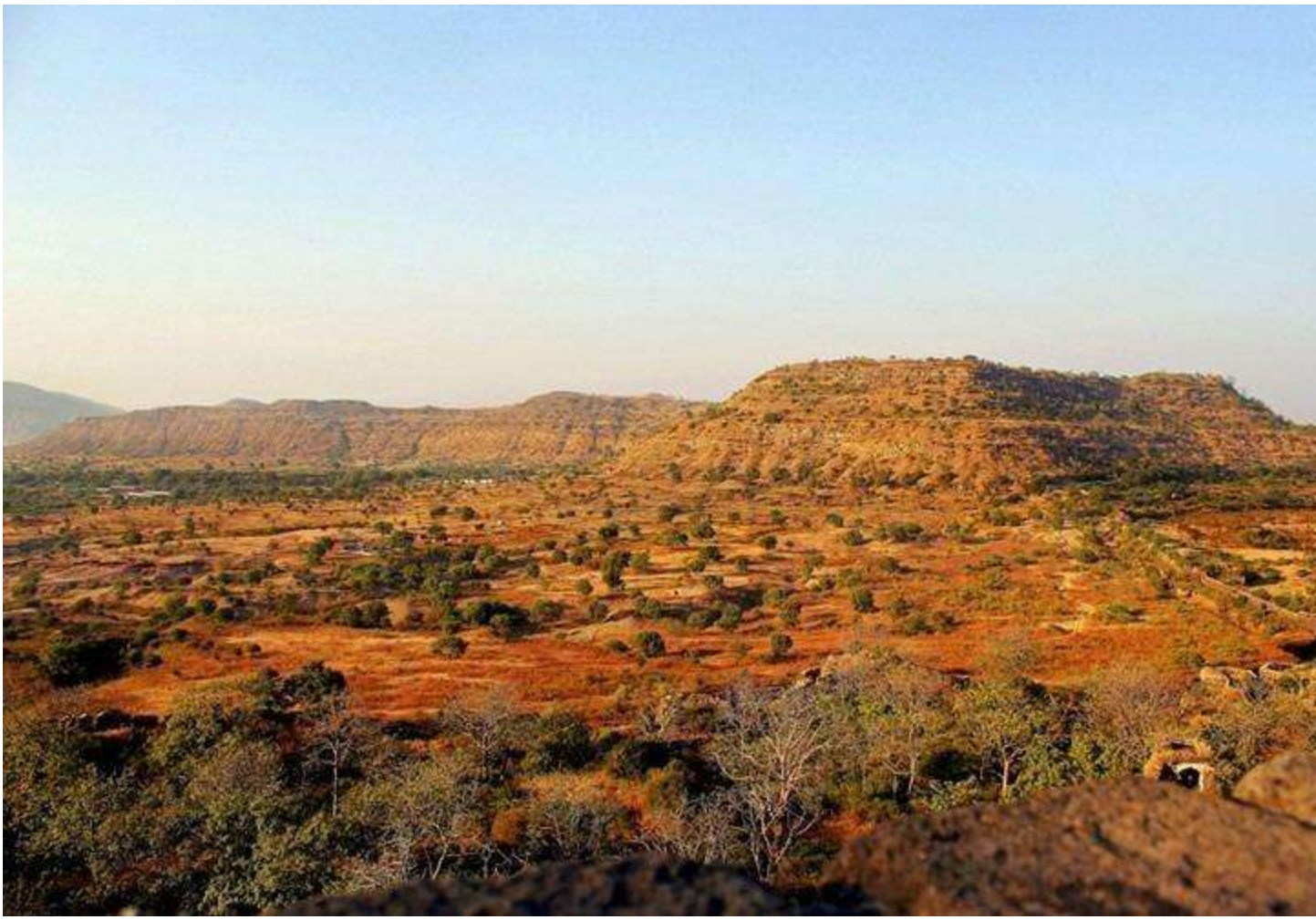
Answer: Bachendri Pal was the first Indian woman to climb Mount Everest. She achieved this feat in 1984.

Q27. Who is Arunima Sinha?

Answer: Arunima Sinha is an Indian mountaineer who climbed Mount Everest in 2013 after losing a leg in an accident.

Topic 3: Plateaus







Q28. What is a plateau?

Answer: A plateau is a raised area of land with a more or less flat surface. Some of its sides have steep slopes.

Q29. Why are plateaus called tablelands?

Answer: Plateaus are called tablelands because their raised, relatively flat surfaces resemble the top of a table.

Q30. Name two important plateaus of the world.

Answer: The Tibetan Plateau and the Deccan Plateau.

Q31. Which is the highest and largest plateau in the world?

Answer: The Tibetan Plateau is the highest and largest plateau in the world.

Q32. Why is the Tibetan Plateau called the Roof of the World?

Answer: It has an average altitude of about 4,500 metres, so it is called the Roof of the World.

Q33. Where is the Deccan Plateau located?

Answer: The Deccan Plateau is located in central and southern India.

Q34. How was the Deccan Plateau formed?

Answer: Much of the Deccan Plateau was formed by volcanic activity millions of years ago.

Q35. Why are plateaus called storehouses of minerals?

Answer: Many plateaus contain valuable mineral deposits. Mining is therefore an important activity in many plateau regions.

Q36. What are the main occupations of people living on plateaus?

Answer: The main occupations include mining, farming, animal rearing, and industries related to minerals.

Q37. What are the advantages of plateaus?

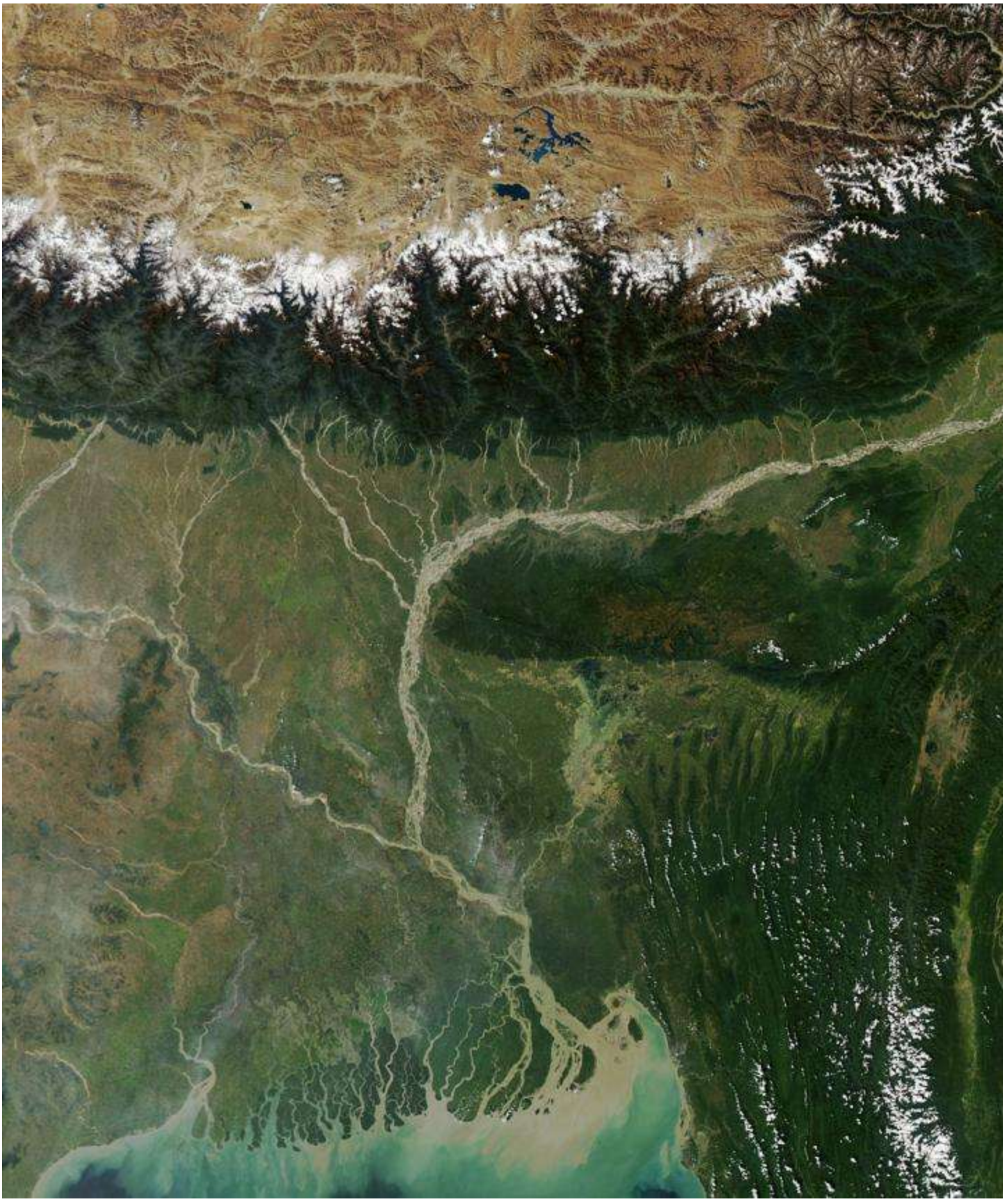
Answer: Plateaus may provide minerals, grazing land, forests, waterfalls, and sites for generating hydroelectric power.

Q38. What challenges do people face in plateau regions?

Answer: Some plateau regions have rocky soil, uneven land, limited water, and difficult transport routes.

Topic 4: Plains







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Q39. What is a plain?

Answer: A plain is a large area of land that is mostly flat or gently sloping.

Q40. How are river plains formed?

Answer: Rivers carry soil and other materials called sediments. When the rivers slow down, they deposit these sediments, gradually forming plains.

Q41. Why are plains usually fertile?

Answer: Rivers deposit fine soil and minerals on plains. This makes many river plains suitable for agriculture.

Q42. Why do many people live in plains?

Answer: Plains usually provide fertile soil, water, easier transport, and suitable land for farming, settlements, and industries.

Q43. Name some important plains of the world.

Answer: The Ganga Plain in India, the Nile Plain in Africa, and the Amazon Plain in South America are important examples.

Q44. What is the Ganga Plain?

Answer: The Ganga Plain is a large fertile plain in northern India formed mainly by sediments deposited by the Ganga and its tributaries.

Q45. What are the main occupations of people living in the Ganga Plain?

Answer: Agriculture, fishing, trade, transport, and various industrial and service activities are important occupations.

Q46. Which crops are grown in the Ganga Plain?

Answer: Rice, wheat, maize, barley, millets, cotton, and jute are among the crops grown there.

Q47. What is a tributary?

Answer: A tributary is a river or stream that flows into a larger river.

Q48. What is a confluence?

Answer: A confluence is the place where two or more rivers meet.

Q49. Why are rivers important to plains?

Answer: Rivers provide water for drinking and irrigation, deposit fertile soil, support fishing, and can be used for transport.

Q50. What problems affect the Ganga Plain?

Answer: The Ganga Plain faces problems such as high population density, pollution, and the depletion of groundwater due to excessive use.

Q51. What is river navigation?

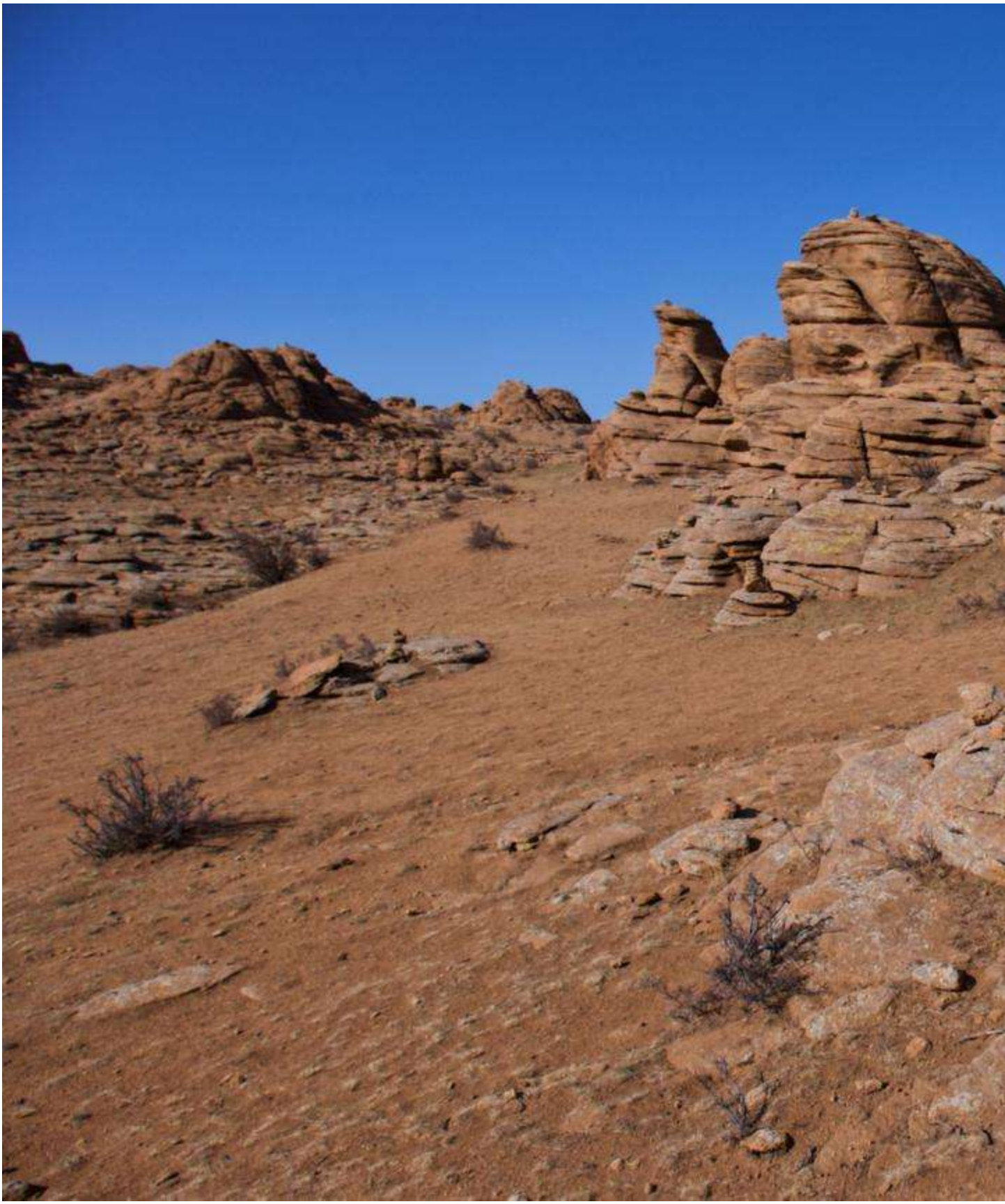
Answer: River navigation means travelling or transporting goods by boats and other vessels along rivers.

Q52. Why is river navigation easier in plains?

Answer: Many rivers in plains flow through gently sloping land, which makes boat transport possible along suitable stretches.

Topic 5: Deserts







Q53. What is a desert?

Answer: A desert is a large, dry area that receives very little rainfall.

Q54. Are all deserts hot?

Answer: No. Some deserts are hot, while others are cold.

Q55. Name two hot deserts.

Answer: The Sahara Desert in Africa and the Thar Desert in India are hot deserts.

Q56. Name a cold desert.

Answer: The Gobi Desert in Asia is a cold desert.

Q57. Why do deserts receive little rainfall?

Answer: Deserts are located in regions where atmospheric conditions, wind patterns, or their distance from moisture sources result in very little rainfall.

Q58. What is desert vegetation?

Answer: Desert vegetation consists of plants adapted to dry conditions, such as cacti, thorny shrubs, and other plants that need little water.

Q59. How do animals survive in deserts?

Answer: Desert animals have special adaptations to save water, tolerate heat or cold, and survive with limited food.

Q60. How have people adapted to life in deserts?

Answer: People use water carefully, wear suitable clothing, keep animals, practise farming where water is available, and develop ways of travelling through dry regions.

Q61. What are the main occupations in the Thar Desert?

Answer: People practise animal rearing, farming where water is available, handicrafts, trade, and tourism.

Q62. What is special about the culture of the Thar Desert?

Answer: The people of the Thar Desert have rich cultural traditions, including folk songs, stories, legends, colourful clothing, and festivals.

Q63. Why is life difficult in deserts?

Answer: Life can be difficult because of water scarcity, extreme temperatures, limited vegetation, and poor soil for farming.

Topic 6: Landforms and Human Culture

Q64. How do landforms influence culture?

Answer: Landforms influence food, clothing, housing, occupations, transport, festivals, and traditions. People develop lifestyles suited to their natural surroundings.

Q65. Why do different landforms have different occupations?

Answer: Different landforms provide different resources and opportunities. For example, plains support farming, plateaus often support mining, and mountains support tourism and animal rearing.

Q66. How are mountains connected with religion?

Answer: Many communities consider mountains sacred. They visit mountain temples and other holy places for worship and pilgrimage.

Q67. Name a sacred mountain in Tibet.

Answer: Mount Kailash is a sacred mountain in Tibet. It is important to followers of Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Bon.

Q68. What are the five tiṇais of ancient Tamil Sangam poetry?

Answer: They are Kuriñji, Mullai, Marudam, Neydal, and Pālai.

Q69. What do the five tiṇais represent?

Answer: They represent five landscapes and their connections with human occupations, lifestyles, emotions, and cultural traditions.

Tiṇai	Landscape	Main occupation
Kuriñji	Mountains	Hunting and gathering
Mullai	Grasslands and forests	Cattle rearing
Marudam	Fertile agricultural plains	Farming
Neydal	Coastal regions	Fishing and seafaring

Pālai Dry, desert-like regions Journeying and fighting

Q70. What do the five tiṇais teach us?

Answer: They show that human life, occupations, and culture are closely connected with the natural environment.

Q71. What is the main message of this chapter?

Answer: Landforms provide different opportunities and challenges. Human beings have adapted to mountains, plateaus, plains, and deserts, developing different ways of life and cultural traditions.

Part B: Textbook Questions and Activities

Question 1. In what type of landform is your town, village, or city located? Which features mentioned in this chapter do you see around you?

Sample answer for Siwan, Bihar:

Siwan is located mainly in the flat alluvial plains of Bihar. The region has agricultural fields, settlements, roads, and fertile soil. Farming is an important activity in the surrounding areas. Rivers and other water sources support agriculture and daily life.

Question 2. Describe the three landforms you encounter when travelling from Chhota Nagpur to Prayagraj and Almora.

Answer:

1. Chhota Nagpur: It is a plateau region with elevated land and rich mineral resources.
2. Prayagraj: It is located in the fertile plains of northern India, near the confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna rivers.
3. Almora: It is located in the mountainous region of Uttarakhand, in the Himalayan foothills.

This journey shows the differences between plateaus, plains, and mountains.

Question 3. List some famous pilgrimage places in India and identify their landforms.

Pilgrimage place	Landform
Kedarnath	Mountains
Badrinath	Mountains
Amarnath	Mountains
Varanasi	River plain
Prayagraj	River plain
Tirupati	Hills
Rameswaram	Coastal region
Somnath	Coastal region

Question 4. State whether the following statements are True or False. Give reasons.

Statement	Answer	Reason
1. The Himalayas are young mountains with rounded tops.	False	The Himalayas are young mountains with many high, rugged peaks.
2. Plateaus usually rise sharply at least on one side.	True	Many plateaus have steep sides.
3. Mountains and hills belong to the same type of landform.	True	Both are elevated landforms, although mountains are generally higher.
4. Mountains, plateaus, and rivers in India have the same types of flora and fauna.	False	Different environments support different plants and animals.
5. The Ganga is a tributary of the Yamuna.	False	The Yamuna is a tributary of the Ganga.
6. Deserts have unique flora and fauna.	True	Plants and animals in deserts are adapted to dry conditions.
7. Melting snow feeds rivers.	True	Meltwater from snow and glaciers supplies water to many rivers.
8. Sediments deposited by rivers make plains fertile.	True	River sediments often contain fine soil and minerals that support agriculture.
9. All deserts are hot.	False	Some deserts, such as the Gobi, are cold.

Question 5. Match the words in pairs.

Word	Correct match
Mount Everest	Roof of the world (the textbook's phrase is more precisely associated with the Tibetan Plateau)
Rafting	River
Camels	Desert
Plateau	Africa (the African Plateau is an example of a plateau region)

Ganga plains	Rice fields
Waterway	Ganga

Question 6. Observe Figure 3.9 (page 54), the satellite image of the Ganga Plain.

Q1. Which colour represents the Ganga Plain?

Answer: The Ganga Plain appears mainly green in the satellite image because of vegetation and agricultural land.

Q2. What does the white expanse represent?

Answer: The white expanse represents the snow-covered Himalayan region.

Q3. What does the brown expanse at the bottom left represent?

Answer: It represents a dry, elevated or plateau region to the south-west of the Ganga Plain.

Question 7. Let's Explore – River sources and confluences

Q. Give examples of river sources or confluences that are considered sacred in India.

Answer:

- Gangotri Glacier: The source region of the Ganga.
- Yamunotri: The source region of the Yamuna.
- Prayagraj: The confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna, traditionally associated with the Saraswati.
- Devprayag: The meeting of the Alaknanda and Bhagirathi rivers, where the Ganga takes its name.

Part C: More Important Exam Questions

Very short-answer questions

Q1. Which is the highest mountain in the world?

Answer: Mount Everest.

Q2. Which plateau is called the Roof of the World?

Answer: The Tibetan Plateau.

Q3. Which plateau is found in central and southern India?

Answer: The Deccan Plateau.

Q4. Which river is associated with the fertile plains of northern India?

Answer: The Ganga.

Q5. Which type of landform is suitable for large-scale farming?

Answer: Plains are generally suitable for large-scale farming.

Q6. Which landform is often rich in minerals?

Answer: Plateaus.

Q7. What is a river tributary?

Answer: A river or stream that flows into a larger river.

Q8. What is the meaning of altitude?

Answer: Height above sea level.

Short-answer questions

Q9. Differentiate between mountains and plateaus.

Answer: Mountains have high peaks and steep slopes. Plateaus are raised areas with relatively flat surfaces and may have steep sides.

Q10. Differentiate between plateaus and plains.

Answer: Plateaus are elevated areas with relatively flat tops. Plains are generally low, flat, or gently sloping areas.

Q11. Why are plains densely populated?

Answer: Plains usually have fertile soil, water, transport facilities, and suitable land for farming and settlements.

Q12. Why are mountains important sources of water?

Answer: Snow and glaciers melt and feed rivers. Mountain rainfall also supplies water to rivers and streams.

Q13. How do humans adapt to different landforms?

Answer: People adapt by changing their houses, clothes, food, occupations, and transport methods according to local conditions.

Q14. Why should mountain environments be protected?

Answer: Mountain environments support forests, wildlife, and rivers. Excessive tourism, deforestation, and pollution can damage these fragile ecosystems.

Q15. How do rivers make plains fertile?

Answer: Rivers deposit sediments containing fine soil and minerals. These deposits help crops grow.

Long-answer questions

Q16. Explain the main characteristics of mountains, plateaus, and plains.

Answer:

- Mountains: They are high landforms with steep slopes and peaks. They provide water, forests, tourism, and grazing areas.
- Plateaus: They are elevated areas with relatively flat surfaces. They often contain minerals and support mining, farming, and industries.
- Plains: They are flat or gently sloping areas. Their fertile soil and easier transport make them suitable for agriculture and settlements.

Q17. Explain the relationship between landforms and human life.

Answer: Landforms influence where people live and how they earn their livelihood. Mountain communities may practise animal rearing and tourism. Plateau regions often support mining and some types of farming. Plains support large populations because of fertile soil and easier transport. Deserts require careful use of water and special adaptations. Thus, landforms influence occupations, food, clothing, houses, transport, and culture.

Q18. Explain the challenges and opportunities of living in different landforms.

Answer: Mountains offer tourism and water resources but have steep slopes and difficult transport. Plateaus provide minerals and grazing land but may have rocky soil and limited water. Plains support farming and settlements but can face floods, pollution, and high population pressure. Deserts have unique wildlife and cultural traditions but suffer from water scarcity and extreme temperatures. People use their skills and knowledge to adapt to these conditions.

Q19. How are landforms connected with Indian culture?

Answer: Landforms are closely connected with Indian culture. Many mountains and rivers are considered sacred. People visit them for pilgrimage, perform religious ceremonies near rivers, and celebrate local festivals. The five landscapes of ancient Tamil Sangam poetry also show how geography influenced people's occupations, emotions, and traditions.

Final Revision: Key Definitions

Term	Simple definition
Landform	A physical feature of the Earth's surface
Mountain	A high landform with steep slopes and a summit
Plateau	An elevated area with a relatively flat surface
Plain	A broad, mostly flat or gently sloping area
Altitude	Height above sea level
Summit	The highest point of a mountain
Valley	A low area between hills or mountains
Terrace farming	Farming on steps cut into slopes
Tributary	A river that flows into a larger river
Confluence	The place where rivers meet
Flora	Plant life of a region
Fauna	Animal life of a region
Resilience	The ability to adapt to and overcome difficulties

Exam preparation tip: Give special attention to the definitions of landforms, the differences between mountains, plateaus and plains, the nine True/False statements, the matching exercise, the five tiṇais, and the relationship between landforms and human life. These topics cover the main learning objectives and textbook exercises of Chapter 3.